

other mechanisms such as dialling. In 1889, Felt went on to bring out the very first printing desk calculator.

Calculators had come of age; it was now time for computers.



Felt's Comptometer: press, don't dial!

1890

It'll seem ridiculous now, but the 1880 US census took seven years to compute—all the “computation” was done by hand! The US government, therefore, in anticipation of the increased population, put out a competition to find a better way. (They didn't want the census computation to take longer than 10 years, for obvious reasons...) So an employee of the census department called Herman Hollerith, borrowing Charles Babbage's idea, used punched cards for data storage. And what might have taken longer than 10 years took six weeks—yes, weeks.

Needless to say, Hollerith won the competition; but needful to say, Hollerith founded, in 1896, the Tabulating Machine Company.

Which went on, in 1924, to merge with another company and become International Business Machines—known more familiarly as IBM.

From rochester.edu (our italics): (Hollerith's) methods, which were used well into the 1960s, offered a foundation for the future collection of all types of data. With his invention Hollerith allowed for the creation of one of the most dominant corporations of the computer age and *secured his place in history as the father of information processing.*



Herman Hollerith founded the Tabulating Machine Company; he is called the Father of Information Processing

1899

And so, at the fag end of the 19th century, lots of things had been invented—not just in com-